2. While this prosperity and the international prestige that went with it were widely reported, observers lamented the greatest unsolved problem in Europe remained German reunification. Commentators mourned that no substantive steps had been taken in that direction or toward a rapprochement between the GDR and FRG.

3. Poland, the GDR and the Soviet Union signed an agreement in Moscow on the construction of the ‘Friendship’ oil pipeline, which secured the supply of Soviet oil to Poland and the GDR.

4. On 16 July 1958, Honecker was also elected a Secretary of the Central Committee. In this capacity, he was occupied with military and security policy, youth policy, trade union policy, the rights of women and the promotion of sports and physical education.

5. Berlin, ADN. 14 July 1958. FBIS-FRB-58-137

6. This would happen, he said, by abrogating the Potsdam Pact and four-power rule and place control of Allied communications to West Berlin in the hands of the East German government (the Allies would not deal with the Ulbricht regime, even as a Soviet agent).

7. New York Times . 11 November 1958.

8. Neue Zeit . 31 December 1959

9. Daily News (London). 26 August 1960

The Sixties

1. The minutes of the Politburo meeting of 28 August 1956 read: ‘Measures for a new housing estate are to be prepared.’

2. After Baumann’s death in 1973, Politburo candidate Werner Jarowinsky, who was responsible for trade and supplies in the Central Committee